

Chapter One - Fundamentals and Initial Mindset (Before Writing Your First Prompt)

1-1: What Exactly Is a Prompt? (The Bridge Between You and AI)

A **prompt**, in the simplest definition, is **your input** to the AI; that is, the text you type and send to the chatbot.

But let's find an appealing metaphor for it:

- Imagine the AI is a **“smart but inexperienced apprentice”** who has just graduated from university. He has read every book in the world, but has not done any of them in practice.
- **The prompt is the job brief** you give this apprentice. If you say, “Write something,” he gets confused. But if you say, “For such-and-such product, write a 3-paragraph sales copy that convinces a 20-year-old audience,” he knows exactly what to do.

So a prompt is not just a “question”; it is a “complete set of instructions.” A prompt is a bridge between “what you mean in your mind” and “the output you want to see on paper.” The stronger and wider this bridge is, the better the AI crosses it and reaches the destination.

1-2: How Does AI Think? (Understanding Tokens and Probability)

This part is very critical, because 90% of prompt-writing problems originate here: **we think AI thinks like a human!**

AI (like ChatGPT or Claude) **does not understand, does not feel**, and has no **human logic**. Rather, it is a **“word prediction machine.”** Let me put it simply:

1. What is a token?

AI does not read words word by word; it converts them into small pieces called “tokens.” For example, the word “prompt-writing” might be converted into 3 or 4 tokens. Every prompt you send is broken down into these tokens.

2. What is probability?

When AI wants to respond, its job is: **“Given the tokens I have seen so far, which is the most likely next token?”**

For example, if you write “The sky’s color is ...”, AI, instead of “thinking,” looks at how many times in books it has seen the word “blue” come after “The sky’s color is” and votes for it with 99% probability. It does this token by token until the sentence is complete.

Important conclusion: Because AI **interpolates** rather than **comprehends**, if you send a vague prompt, it gives the most probable vague response (which is usually clichéd and

worthless). But if you send a precise prompt, it finds the most precise path among its data.

1-3: The Right Mindset: Commanding Instead of Asking (The Difference Between a Command and a Question)

This is a common mistake among all beginners. Many talk to AI like a polite human and ask:

| *“Can you help me write an article?”*

AI politely replies: *“Yes, of course, I’d be happy to help”* — and then **writes no article!** Because you only asked a yes/no question.

The right mindset is: AI is a **“tool,”** not a **“colleague.”** A tool must be given **commands**, not asked questions.

- **Question:** Comes back to you and waits for your approval. (Can you? How about?)
- **Command:** Goes straight to the output. (Write, analyze, translate, summarize)

Example of the difference:

- **✗ Question:** *“Can you give me 5 ideas for growing this Instagram page?”*
(Response: “Yes, of course!” and that’s it!)
- **✓ Command:** *“Write 5 practical and low-cost ideas for growing an Instagram account in the language-teaching niche, and give each one on a separate line with a one-sentence explanation.”*
(Response: you receive those 5 ideas)

From now on, start your prompts with an **imperative verb**: design, write, analyze, compare, convert, summarize.

1-4: The Golden Rule: “Low-Quality Input = Low-Quality Output” (GIGO)

This rule is old in computer science: **Garbage In, Garbage Out.**

Many people become disappointed after the first prompt and say: “AI is useless! It gives nonsense answers!” while the problem is with themselves.

Let’s unpack this rule with a concrete example:

Low-quality input (bad prompt)	Low-quality output (bad response)
"Write me a diet"	A general and repetitive diet: "Breakfast: bread and cheese, lunch: rice and chicken..." (completely generic and useless)

High-quality input (good prompt)	High-quality output (excellent response)
"For a 35-year-old man weighing 90 kg and 175 cm tall who sits at a desk 8 hours a day and is allergic to eggs, write a 7-day meal plan for losing 2 kg, along with a weekly shopping list."	A precise, personalized plan, including calorie counts, egg-free alternatives, and even meal timing.

Four reasons why input becomes low-quality:

1. **Vagueness:** The topic is ambiguous (like "Write about history").
2. **Lack of context:** AI does not know for whom, where, and why you are writing.
3. **No specific request:** It does not know what form you want the output in.
4. **No constraints:** Length, time, or level of expertise is not specified.

Practical assignment for Chapter One (to make sure you've learned it):

Go to an AI (or just do it in your mind here) and compare these two prompts:

1. Bad prompt: *"Explain content marketing."*
2. Good prompt (following points 1 to 4): *"As a marketing expert, write a 5-step guide to starting content marketing for a small, newly founded online store. The tone should be formal but friendly, and explain each step in 2 lines."*

You felt the difference, didn't you? :)

Chapter One Conclusion:

A prompt is a communication bridge. AI is a statistical predictor, not a human. Instead of asking, command. And always remember that **the quality of the output is an exact translation of the quality of your input.**